

ISO 45001 Certification Checklist for UK Businesses

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How to use this checklist

Work through each section before your Stage 2 certification audit. Every item marked **Required** must be evidenced — not just documented, but demonstrably operating. Items marked **Recommended** are best practice that auditors will look for. Tick each box as you confirm it is in place.

1. Context and Scope

Item	Status	✓
Organisational context documented Internal and external issues relevant to OH&S; and the OHSMS are identified and documented (Clause 4.1).	Required	☐
Interested parties identified Workers, contractors, visitors, regulators, trade unions, and other relevant parties are listed with their OH&S-relevant; needs and expectations (Clause 4.2).	Required	☐
OHSMS scope formally defined The scope states which activities, sites, and worker groups are included. Exclusions are justified (Clause 4.3).	Required	☐
Scope reflects operational reality Remote workers, sub-contractors, temporary workers, and visiting personnel are appropriately accounted for within or excluded from scope with justification.	Required	☐

2. Leadership and Worker Participation

Item	Status	✓
OH&S; policy approved and communicated Policy is signed by top management, includes commitments to prevention of injury and ill health, legal compliance, and continual improvement (Clause 5.2).	Required	■
OH&S; roles and responsibilities assigned Named individuals are accountable for OHSMS performance at appropriate levels. Responsibilities are documented (Clause 5.3).	Required	■
Top management demonstrably involved ISO 45001 explicitly requires leadership commitment. Auditors will interview senior leaders — they must be able to discuss OH&S; objectives and demonstrate active involvement (Clause 5.1).	Required	■
Worker participation and consultation evidenced Processes for worker participation in hazard identification, risk assessment, and incident investigation are in place and operating. This is one of the most distinctive requirements of ISO 45001 versus OHSAS 18001 (Clause 5.4).	Required	■
Management review conducted and minuted At least one formal management review covering the inputs required by Clause 9.3 has taken place, with minutes retained.	Required	■

3. Hazard Identification and Risk Assessment

Item	Status	✓
Hazard identification process documented A systematic process for identifying OH&S; hazards — covering routine and non-routine activities, emergencies, and changes — is documented and operating (Clause 6.1.2).	Required	■
Risk assessment completed for all significant hazards Risks associated with identified hazards have been assessed and risk levels documented. The hierarchy of controls has been applied (Clause 6.1.2).	Required	■
Opportunities for improvement identified As well as risks, the process must identify opportunities to improve OH&S; performance (Clause 6.1.2).	Required	■
Legal and other requirements register maintained All applicable OH&S; legislation — HASAWA, MHSWR, COSHH, RIDDOR, LOLER, PUWER, and any sector-specific regulations — is identified and current (Clause 6.1.3).	Required	■
Legal compliance evaluated A documented evaluation of compliance with each applicable legal requirement is conducted at planned intervals. This goes beyond knowing what the law requires — it requires evidence of compliance evaluation (Clause 9.1.2).	Required	■
Risk assessments reviewed following incidents or changes Risk assessments are reviewed after incidents, near-misses, or significant operational changes — not just on a fixed annual cycle.	Required	■

4. Planning and Objectives

Item	Status	✓
OH&S; objectives set and measurable Objectives are documented, measurable, and have plans for achievement including resources, responsibilities, and timescales (Clause 6.2).	Required	■
Emergency preparedness procedures in place Documented procedures for potential emergency situations relevant to the organisation are in place and have been tested (Clause 8.2).	Required	■
Management of change process operating A process for managing planned changes — new equipment, processes, personnel, or locations — that could affect OH&S; performance (Clause 8.1.3).	Recommended	■
Contractor and procurement controls in place Processes for communicating OH&S; requirements to contractors and suppliers, and for verifying their compliance, are documented and operating (Clause 8.1.4).	Required	■

5. Documentation and Competence

Item	Status	✓
OH&S; policy and objectives documented Current, approved policy and objectives are available as documented information.	Required	■
Competence records maintained Records of training, qualifications, and experience are held for all personnel whose work could affect OH&S; — including induction records for new starters and contractors (Clause 7.2).	Required	■
Awareness training conducted All workers are aware of the OH&S; policy, their contribution to OHSMS effectiveness, the implications of not conforming, and relevant hazards and controls (Clause 7.3).	Required	■
Incident records maintained Records of incidents, near-misses, and ill health are maintained. RIDDOR reportable events are recorded and reported to HSE within statutory timescales.	Required	■
Document control process operating Documents are reviewed, approved, version-controlled, and outdated versions are withdrawn (Clause 7.5).	Required	■

6. Internal Audit

Item	Status	✓
Audit programme documented A planned audit programme covering all OHSMS processes, requirements, and higher-risk activities over a defined period is in place (Clause 9.2).	Required	■
Audit programme is risk-based Higher-risk operations, areas with previous nonconformances, and recent changes receive greater audit scrutiny. A flat schedule auditing every area equally does not meet the standard's intent.	Required	■
Internal audit conducted At least one complete internal audit cycle has been completed before Stage 2, with results documented.	Required	■
Audit tests effectiveness, not just documentation Auditors observe work activities, interview workers, and test whether controls are actually operating — not just whether procedures exist.	Required	■
Auditors are objective and impartial Internal auditors do not audit their own work. Independence is documented.	Required	■
Audit findings addressed All nonconformities identified during internal audit have corrective actions with target dates and evidence of completion or progress.	Required	■

7. Incident Investigation and Continual Improvement

Item	Status	✓
Incident investigation process documented A documented process for investigating incidents and near-misses to determine root causes and prevent recurrence (Clause 10.2).	Required	■
Incidents investigated promptly Investigations are conducted in a timely manner. Root cause analysis — not just description of what happened — is documented.	Required	■
Corrective actions address root causes Actions address underlying causes, not just symptoms. Effectiveness of corrective actions is verified after implementation.	Required	■
Continual improvement evidenced At least one demonstrable improvement to the OHSMS based on audit results, incidents, or management review is available (Clause 10.3).	Required	■
Performance monitoring data collected Leading and lagging indicators — near-miss frequency, training completion, inspection results, incident rates — are monitored and reviewed (Clause 9.1).	Required	■

1. Worker participation is documented as a policy but cannot be evidenced in practice — no records of consultation, involvement in risk assessment, or toolbox talks.
2. Legal compliance evaluation is missing — the legal register lists applicable legislation but there is no evidence of compliance evaluation against each requirement.
3. Risk assessments have not been reviewed following incidents or operational changes — static documents that predate current activities.
4. Contractor controls are absent — principal contractors or clients are asked for evidence that sub-contractors' safety is managed, and none exists.
5. Top management cannot demonstrate involvement — health and safety is entirely delegated to a safety officer with no director-level engagement evident.

Need help getting ISO 45001 certified?

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